

Michael Yao

michael.yao@yale.edu · michael-zt-yao.github.io

Education	Yale University 2023-2027 <i>BA Economics and Mathematics. 4.0/4.0 GPA.</i> • <i>Awards:</i> Phi Beta Kappa (top 42 students in year), top in course in General Equilibrium Theory, Real Analysis, Intensive Macroeconomic Theory. • <i>Other courses:</i> Functional Analysis, Intermediate Machine Learning, Data Economics (CS, PhD), Labour Economics (PhD), Econometrics (intensive).
Experience	Research Assistant for Prof. Pascual Restrepo February 2026 - • Working on projects about new technologies and labour market inequality.
	Intern , New Zealand Treasury (Te Tai Ōhanga) <i>Analytics and Insights Team</i> June - August 2025 • Worked with administrative tax data (full population of 5 million over 10 years) in R to study transitions out of poverty.
	Research Assistant for Prof. John Geanakoplos June 2024 - May 2025 • Microsimulation modelling of the US Social Security system with Professors John Geanakoplos (Yale) and Stephen Zeldes (Columbia). • Estimated an original stochastic process to model labour incomes on ~50 years of US individual-level tax data (~60 million observations).
	Research Assistant for Prof. Annie Harper June - December 2024 • Coauthored a paper about debt and fintech use by people experiencing homelessness. Interviewed 20 unhoused people in New Haven, Connecticut.
Leadership and Service	Volunteer Income Tax Assistance (VITA) , <i>Volunteer tax preparer</i> 2025 - Filing taxes for low-income local residents. Claimed over \$30,000 in refunds for clients.
	Yale Salus Populi Foundation (International development society) 2023 - 2025 Taught ~20 undergraduate fellows about international development and ran speaker events, including with former Chief Economist of USAID Dean Karlan.
	Yale Kendo Club (martial art), <i>President</i> 2024 - Present
Skills	Mathematical and statistical computing Python (NumPy, SciPy, Pandas, tensorflow, parallel computing in dask), R (tidyverse, econometrics packages), MATLAB. Can read Fortran and Stata.
	Other software GitHub, Anaconda (Python package management), L ^A T _E X, HTML and CSS.